



Party member
GERMANY

This membership book, dated July 15, 1937, certified that the holder was a member of the Nazi party, the ruling party in Germany during World War II.

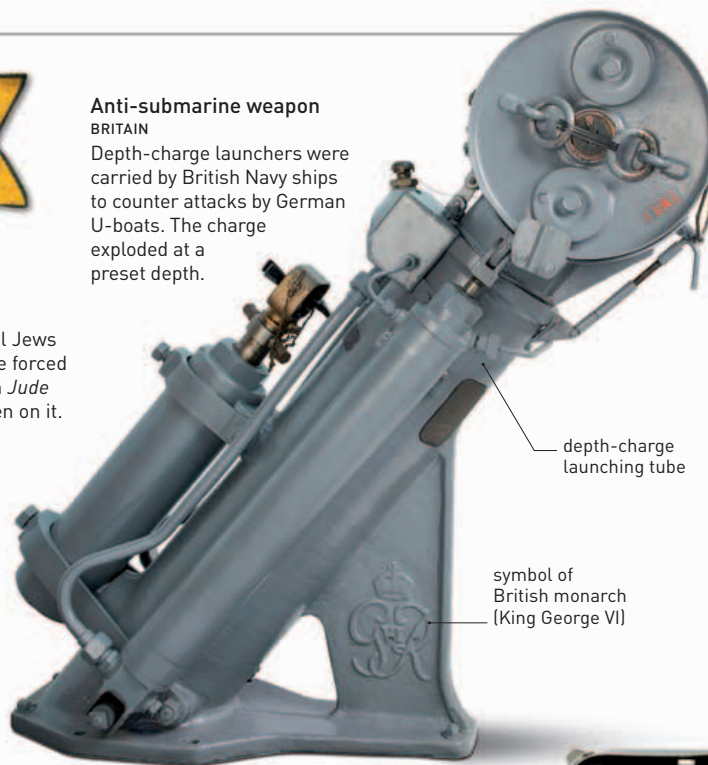


Yellow star
GERMANY

From September 1941, all Jews in the German Reich were forced to wear a yellow star with *Jude* (German for "Jew") written on it.

Anti-submarine weapon
BRITAIN

Depth-charge launchers were carried by British Navy ships to counter attacks by German U-boats. The charge exploded at a preset depth.



depth-charge launching tube

symbol of British monarch (King George VI)



French Canadian poster
CANADA

This poster, addressed to Canada's French-speaking population, appeals for naval volunteers to join the fight against German U-boats.

SS motto



SS dagger
GERMANY

Ceremonial daggers were issued to all members of the Nazi elite SS. The blade bears the SS motto *Meine Ehre heißt Treue* ("My Honor is Loyalty").

symbol of the Third Reich

WORLD WAR II

A GLOBAL CONFLICT THAT INVOLVED NOT ONLY MILITARY PERSONNEL BUT ALSO CIVILIANS

World War II cost more lives than any other conflict in human history. Battle was joined on land, at sea, and in the air, with weapons ranging from the bolt-action rifle to the atomic bomb.

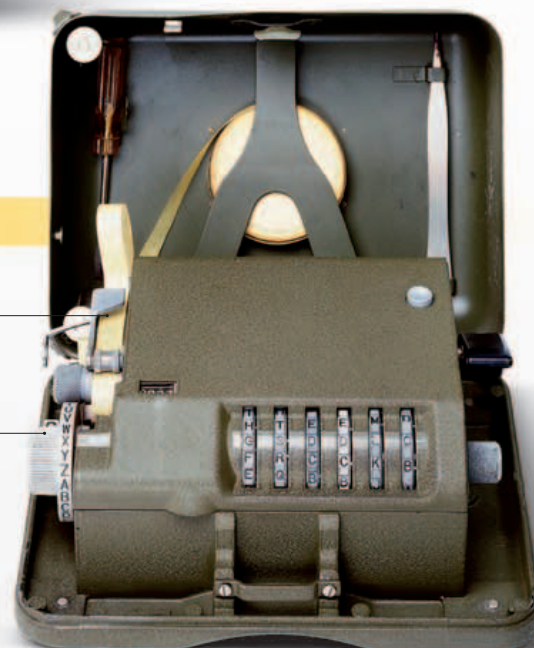
World War II involved more than 100 million military personnel and most nations of the world. As well as being the most widespread war in history, it was also marked by mass casualties among civilians, who were subjected to large-scale aerial bombardment, massacre by German and Japanese soldiers and security forces, and the dropping of atomic bombs on Japan.

paper tape on which encrypted message was printed

setting knob

Cipher machine
US

The M-209 was a mechanical cipher machine that provided swift and basic encryption, providing sufficient security for use on the battlefield.



rifle bolt



Lee Enfield bolt-action rifle
BRITAIN

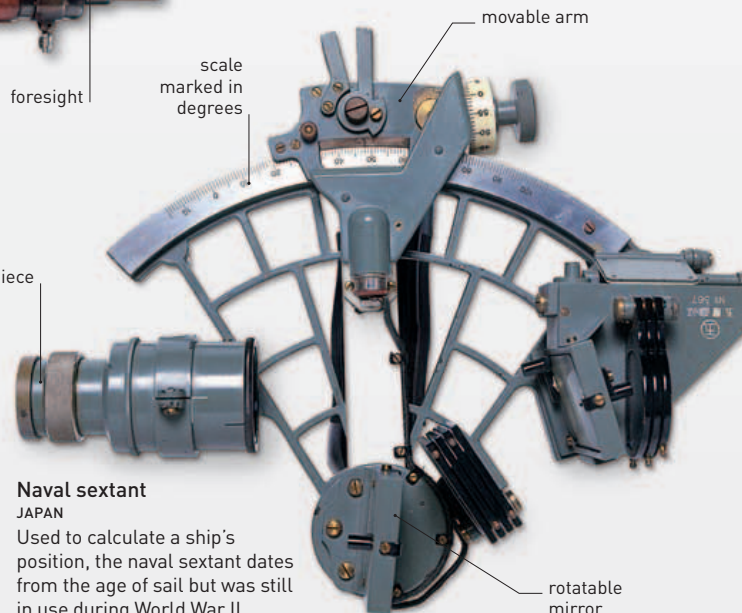
This rifle, which fired .303 cartridges from a 10-round magazine, was the standard British and Commonwealth infantry rifle in both world wars.

foresight

scale marked in degrees

movable arm

eyepiece



Naval sextant
JAPAN

Used to calculate a ship's position, the naval sextant dates from the age of sail but was still in use during World War II.

rotatable mirror

Field telephone
US

Portable telephones, such as the American EE8 shown here, were used for battlefield communication over relatively short distances.



Prayer card
JAPAN

This wooden prayer card belonged to a Buddhist Japanese serviceman. Troops of all nations sought comfort in religion and in superstition.

